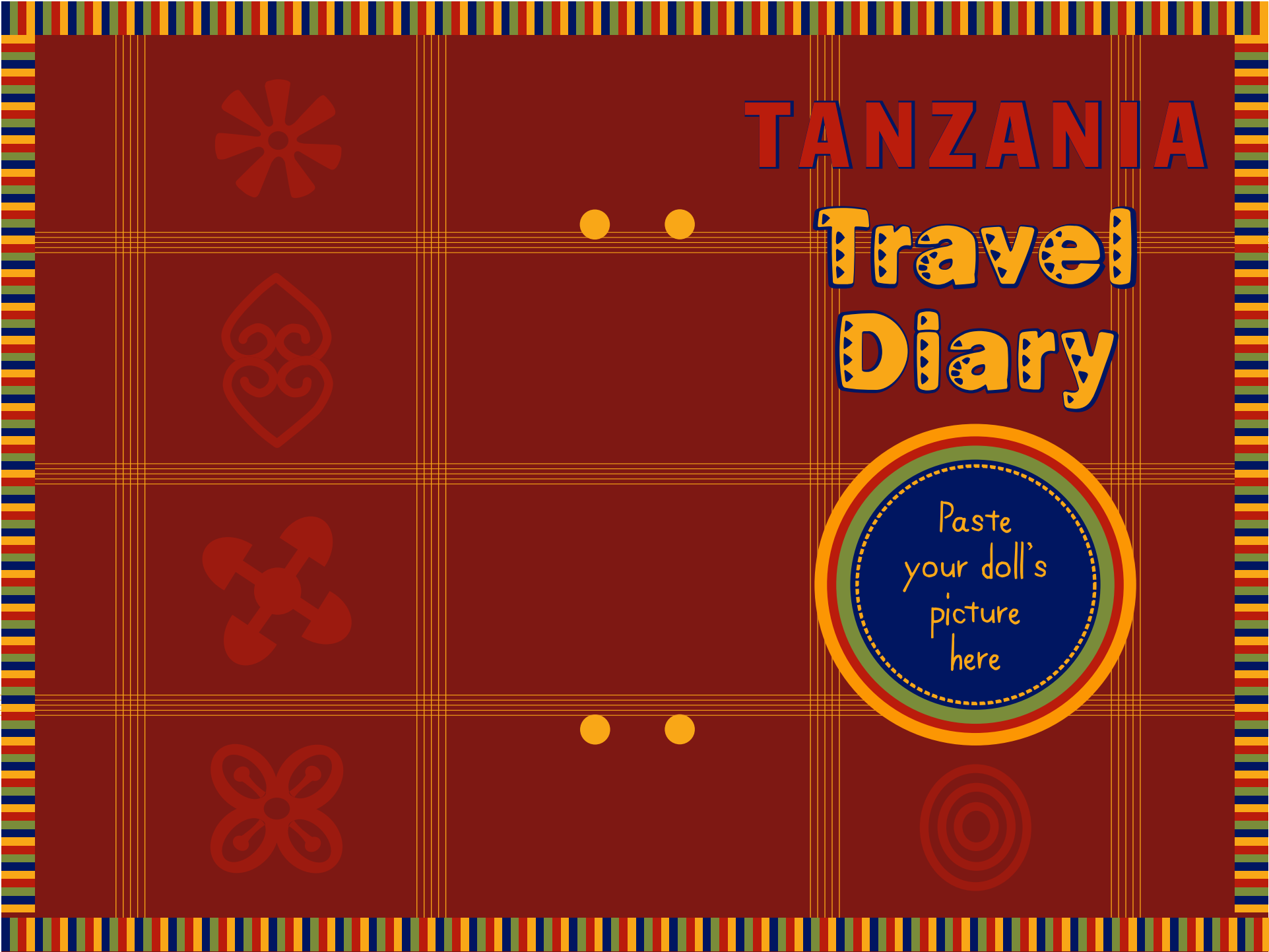


The cover features a dark red background with a grid of thin yellow lines. The left side is divided into four vertical panels, each containing a different red geometric pattern: a starburst, a heart-like shape with internal swirls, a four-lobed flower, and a five-petaled flower. The right side has a large yellow circle with a blue center containing the text 'Paste your doll's picture here'. The top and bottom edges are decorated with a wide border of multi-colored vertical stripes. The title 'TANZANIA' is in red block letters with a blue outline, and 'Travel Diary' is in yellow block letters with a blue outline and a patterned texture.

TANZANIA

Travel Diary

Paste
your doll's
picture
here

Tanzania - Day 1

4:00 p.m.

Dear Diary,

After a long journey, we've arrived in Tanzania! We're in Arusha, which is kind of the home base for lots of the safaris here. Our hotel is on an old coffee plantation and my room has a view of Mt. Meru, which is a huge peak with a crater at the top. Wow! The sun is setting now and the clouds around the mountain are all orange and gold. I can't believe I'm in Africa—and that tomorrow we're going to start our safari!

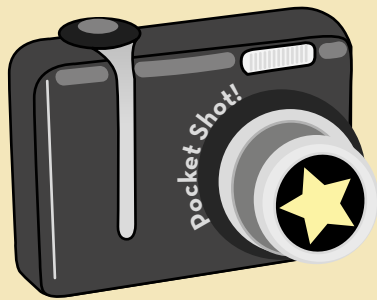
Day 2

11:40 a.m.

Dear Diary,

So much to tell you! This morning we flew (in a *little* plane!) to the Serengeti to start our safari. We arrived at our camp, which was already set up with tents and everything, then piled into three Land Rovers with the rest of the group to go out and see the animals. The Serengeti National Park is what you usually think of when you imagine a safari: a huge, grassy plain where all kinds of animals graze and wander.

early for the “great migration” — that’s when millions of wildebeest move from one place to the other— but we’re just in time to see lots of baby animals! I’ve seen baby giraffes (six feet tall!) and ostriches and lots of gazelle babies on their shaking, tiny little stick legs. Now we’re having a picnic lunch in the park, then more driving around to see more animals. My camera is going to be SO full!!



5:00 p.m.

Dear Diary,

The sun has gone down and we’re about to have dinner in camp. It’s a pretty good camp, with bottled water and towels and everything. Of course we have mosquito nets to keep out the bugs when we’re in bed. My arm is still kind of sore from the shot I had to get to come to Africa, and we have to take malaria pills. But it was worth it! Dinner smells really delicious, I think they’re grilling some meat over the fire. Anyway, this afternoon I saw a family of warthogs, they were so ugly they were cute! And there

were four little ones squealing and running after their mom. The guides said they are dangerous animals to get near. No problem, I wasn't about to try! We also saw baboons (*not* my favorite animals!) and on the way back to camp, the guide found a little African hedgehog, all curled up in a ball with his prickly spines sticking out. He made snuffly noises like an old man with a head cold. The spines were very sharp; I'd never want to accidentally step on one with my bare feet!

The moon is coming up and you can hear lions roaring in the dark, Diary!

I'm glad there are a lot of us in the camp, because I would *not* want to hear that sound all by myself, even in a tent!

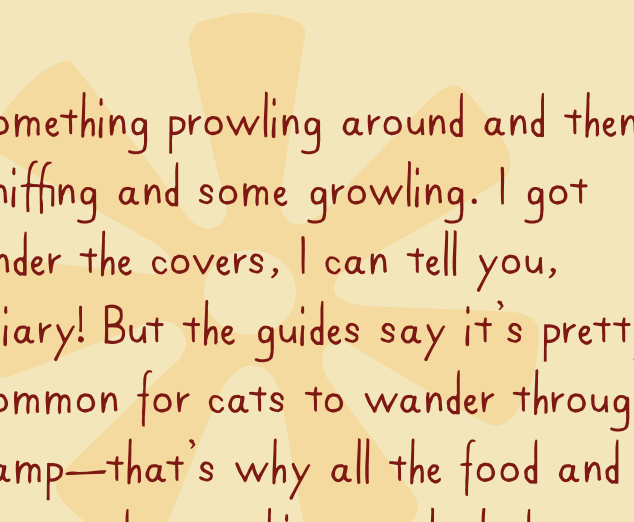


Day 3

7:00 a.m.

Dear Diary,

Okay, I had to get up early and write this, because last night a *leopard* came through our camp! I just heard

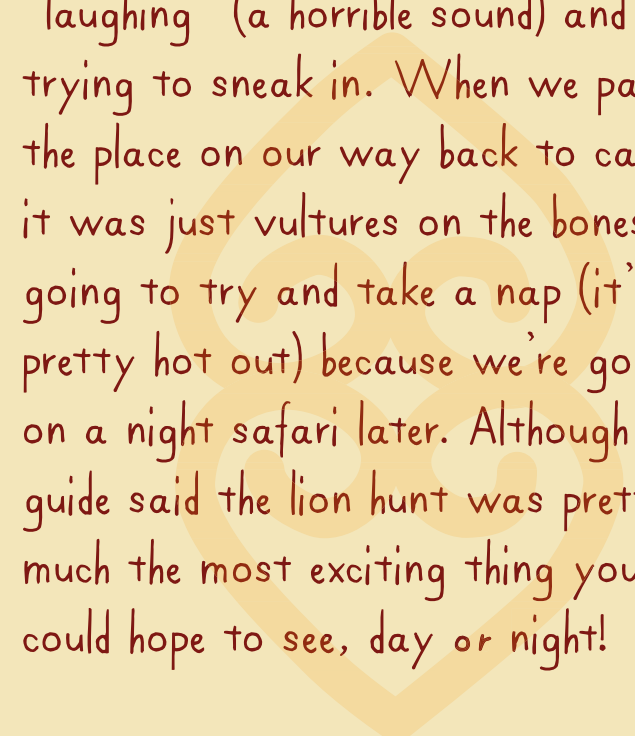


something prowling around and then sniffing and some growling. I got under the covers, I can tell you, Diary! But the guides say it's pretty common for cats to wander through camp—that's why all the food and pots and everything are locked up tight! The leopard just went away, nobody hurt him and he didn't hurt anyone. Whew.

2:00 p.m.

Dear Diary,

Today was a little upsetting. We saw lions kill and eat a wildebeest. Two lionesses did the hunting and although you see things like this on



television, it's much faster and exciting and sad when it's in real life. I mean, I know they have to eat—they have babies, too—but the poor wildebeest! The lions settled down to eat and of course the hyenas were “laughing” (a horrible sound) and trying to sneak in. When we passed the place on our way back to camp, it was just vultures on the bones. I'm going to try and take a nap (it's pretty hot out) because we're going on a night safari later. Although the guide said the lion hunt was pretty much the most exciting thing you could hope to see, day or night!

Day 4

7:30 a.m.

Dear Diary,

The night safari was amazing. We drove around using a floodlight on the top of the Land Rover to try and see animals. We saw a **genet** in a tree—it looks like a cross between a leopard and a lemur, because it has a spotted body but a striped fluffy tail and it hisses and climbs trees but isn't really a cat. The guide said they are related to mongoose. Some people have them as pets! But they mostly like to come out at night, so I don't think that would be much fun as a

pet. They're pretty shy, too. We also saw lions (and their eyes are super glowing green at night!), hyenas, African dogs, and a small herd of elephants. I wasn't sure it was a good idea to bother sleeping elephants. Would you want a big light in your face all of a sudden? Everything looks a little spooky at night on the plains. But I wouldn't have missed it.



5:30 p.m.

Dear Diary,

Another day of driving and seeing animals. My favorite was the cheetah, because not everyone gets to see a cheetah on safari. They are the fastest animals on earth, running up to 70 miles per hour—that's as fast as a car on the freeway! Although they can't keep it up for very long, of course, they're made for sprinting really fast after prey. Although they're cats, they can't retract their claws back into their paws like other cats can. It's too bad there are so few of them left in the wild now.

Something else you don't think about in Africa very much are the birds—but you can see more than 500 species of birds in the Serengeti alone! One of my favorites was the tiny Fisher's Lovebirds, which are so bright orange and green that they look like little flying popsicles! We also saw Secretary birds, which are like eagles on stilts, because their legs are so long. They were named Secretary birds because they have long feathers on their heads that reminded someone of secretaries (men secretaries—and a long time ago!) with quill pens tucked behind their ears. I think that's a weird way

to get a name! We saw one catch and kill a snake. Gross. Tomorrow we leave for Ngorongoro Crater.

Day 5

10:40 a.m.

Dear Diary,

Some people call Ngorongoro Crater the eighth wonder of the world. It certainly is amazing. We drove through forest up the sides of the mountain until it opened up into a 10-mile wide collapsed volcano crater that's become a flat grassland filled with animals. I've already seen so

many animals, Diary—elephants, baboons, birds, and wildebeests, all next to each other and walking around. There were so many baby wildebeest! They are also kind of ugly cute, like the warthogs. Wildebeest look like someone put together an animal out of parts that don't fit together too well. Cow heads and antelope legs and giraffe shoulders—I don't know! Just weird looking. But they can run! And when they migrate, the plains shake under their hooves. That's what they say, anyhow.

4:20 p.m.

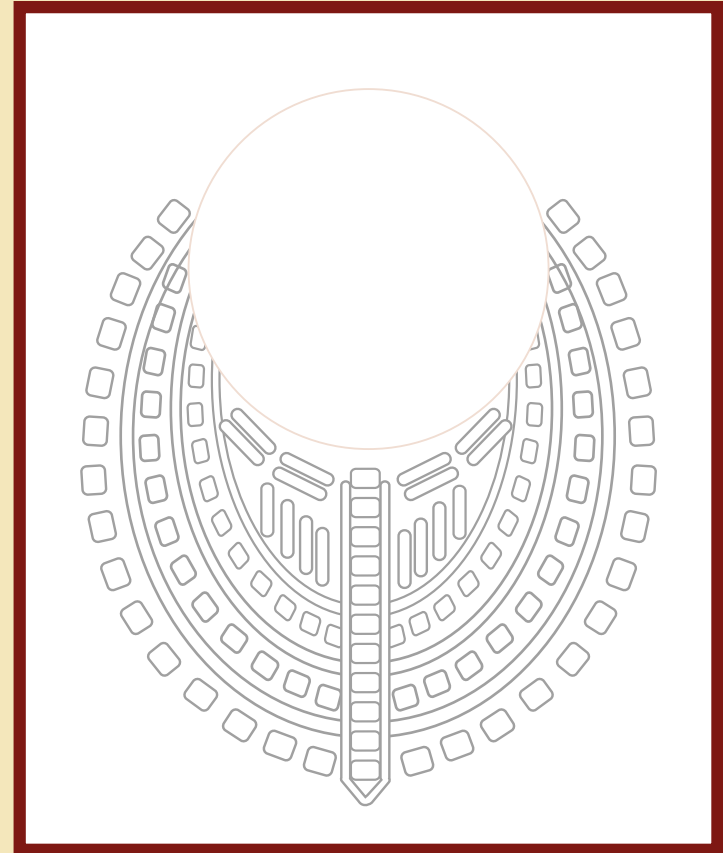
Dear Diary,

Ngorongoro Crater is one of the few places in the world where you can see black rhinos. Our guide talked to some Maasai and they told us where a rhino had been sighted recently. So we went there and waited and waited and finally saw one black rhinoceros. It was a male and our guide said that it weighed over 2,000 pounds! So if a rhino sat on you...well...bye! Black rhinos are really just grayish white, same as white rhinos, isn't that silly? They have two horns.

The Maasai people we met wore mostly dark, bright colors of red or blue. The women wore beautiful beaded jewelry that they made themselves. Our guide said the Maasai traditionally use cattle as a way to measure wealth—the more cattle, the wealthier someone is—and they mix cattle blood with their milk sometimes, as a special drink. Diary, the more I see of the world, the more I realize how different people may *think* about things—but I also realize how alike they usually *feel* about things. Customs are different, but our feelings are the same everywhere.

Activity: Maasai necklace

Color this beautiful Maasai necklace with bead colors that mean something: red=bravery, blue=the sky, green=the land, orange=friendship, white=purity/health, and black=people



Instructions: Print and paste a photo of your doll's head to complete the picture.

Day 6

11:00 a.m.

Dear Diary,

Today we are at Lake Manyara.

There are hundreds of flamingos wading through the shallows, and dozens of hippos in the pools, Diary! They are one of my favorite animals! I love the way their ears wiggle when they're in the water. I couldn't stop watching them. And guess what?

We're staying in a *tree house*! It's so awesome! They have real beds and sofas and bathrooms, just like a normal house (except for the outdoor

shower, which I love!). But the walls are sliding doors, so you can keep them open and feel what it's like to be living high in a mahogany tree. There's only one thing that makes me nervous, Diary. Lake Manyara is famous for lions that climb trees! That's one houseguest I'd rather *not* have, if you don't mind!



4:00 p.m.

Dear Diary,

We had fresh fish for lunch in the open-air *boma*, and then went for a bush walk with a guide. This place has tiny antelope! The *dik-dik* is about as big as a cat and the *Klipspringer* (that means "rock jumper") is the size of a small dog. I wanted to take some home and keep them in our back yard! Do you think Coconut would have liked that? We also saw an African hornbill, which is a big bird (bigger than the *dik-dik*!) that nests in the hollow of a tree. The female goes in the nest, and then the male fills

up most of the entrance hole with mud and stuff, so only her beak sticks out (and they have really long beaks, like toucans). Then she stays there, and he feeds her through the hole until their babies are hatched and ready to leave the nest. Kind of like being grounded and having to stay in your room! I wonder if the females *like* being stuck in there all that time?

8:30 p.m.

Dear Diary,

I watched the sun going down over the lake and then went through all my photos back at the tree house. It's our

last day on safari. Tomorrow we fly back to Arusha and then onto a big plane for home. I can't believe there are all these animals in the world, Diary. It's even harder to believe that many more are no longer alive because people have hunted them for stupid reasons—like making magic medicine (that doesn't even work!) from their horns, or rugs from their skin, or tables from their legs. I don't know why we can't share the Earth with animals, instead of treating them like we're special and they're not. I love it here in Tanzania—and I feel sad to go.

Day 7 - 2:00 p.m.

Dear Diary,

We're in the plane flying home, Diary, so this is my last entry. I've been so many places and seen so many wonderful things. I'm glad that Africa was on the list because it's made me want to help, somehow. When I get back to America, I'm going to see what I can do to make life better for the animals on our planet. Who knows? Maybe I'll even be a zoologist when I grow up! Or a veterinarian. I'm looking out of the plane and I can see Mount Kilimanjaro below. *Kwaheri*, Tanzania! Goodbye!